

A note on how this book was made

This book argues that AI can quietly erode the friction that produces shared understanding when we let it replace the conversations that build it. It was written with Claude. I'm aware of the irony.

The ideas, the stories, the framing: those are mine. But I'm not a natural writer. I struggle to structure an argument, and I miss my own contradictions. Claude closed that gap and made writing this possible at all. The moments that changed the book came from outside my own framing: readers pushing back on the argument, especially once I published it as a blog series before the book was finished. Matthias asking "why do I need the team" did more for this book than any private editing pass could have. That pushback is the mechanism this book argues for, just in public rather than in a room.

Matthias, Johann, Bernhard, Carla, and Giulia read the first version of this book. It was the rough one, before any of this held together, and they told me what wasn't working. Thank you for getting through it.

I still don't know if that was enough. Judge for yourself. That's what the rest of this book is for.